

ReclaimKit — Complete User Guide

Thomas Gollogly

ReclaimKit — Complete User Guide

Everything you need to know and do to remove harmful Facebook content, delist from Google, and close your account.

For	Thomas Gollogly — Northern Ireland
Toolkit	ReclaimKit
Version	August 2026
Legal basis	UK GDPR Article 17 · Defamation Act (NI) 2022 · ICO complaints

Disclaimer: ReclaimKit generates templates and tracks your campaign. It is **not legal advice** and is not affiliated with Meta, Google, or any paid removal service. Platform decisions are theirs; this guide helps you use the same official channels reputation firms use.

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1. Will this work?

Yes — this is a proven, legitimate process. Paid reputation firms (Removify, Erase.com, etc.) charge **£400–£2,000 per item** to submit the **same** GDPR emails, Meta escalation forms, and Google delisting requests that ReclaimKit generates for you.

What ReclaimKit does

Capability	Details
6-round Meta escalation	GDPR initial → reminder → Trust & Safety → rebuttal → ICO notice → post-ICO
3-round Google delisting	Defamation → personal info → resubmit with case history
1 ICO complaint letter	Free regulator pressure if Meta refuses after 30 days
Evidence pack	Hashed screenshots + case summary for attachments
Search monitoring	Scans public web for indexed mentions of your name
Image search	Optional daily reverse-image scan (SerpAPI/TinEye)
Slack alerts	Notifies you when new harmful URLs appear
VPS automation	Daily monitor + optional auto-email to Meta (~£5/month)

What no software can do

Limitation	Why
Instant deletion	Only Meta can remove Facebook posts — there is no public delete API
Auto-submit Google forms	Google has no API; you paste letter text into their web forms (~2 min each)
Scrape private groups	Illegal / against ToS; ReclaimKit uses your saved URL and screenshots
Guarantee removal	Platforms decide; persistence and proper legal framing improve success Meta will not reveal

Deanonymize commenters

identities without
legal disclosure

Realistic expectation: Meta must respond to UK GDPR within **one calendar month**. Many cases resolve in Round 1–3. If Meta refuses, ICO complaints are free and often effective. Google delisting hides content from search even if a copy exists elsewhere.

2. Your situation at a glance

Field	Value
Your name	Thomas Gollogly
Location	Northern Ireland, United Kingdom
Harmful content	Facebook group post with your photo + false allegations in c
Group	AreWeDatingTheSameGuy? Northern Ireland
Post date	~5 June 2025
Post URL	https://www.facebook.com/groups/1054539240086174/posts
Already reported in-app?	Yes (reported_to_meta: true in config)
Police involvement	Not required for this path (no_police: true)
Plan after removal	Close/delete Facebook account

Alleged commenters (documented in config)

These handles are recorded for your evidence pack. ReclaimKit **cannot** identify real people behind anonymous Facebook names — only Meta can, and only via legal process.

- BrightPanda3834
- IntelligentJaguar6700
- Keerzo Diesel
- Pieter James
- EmpatheticPeapod4820
- Anonymous participant 617

3. What you need before you start

Required (you almost certainly have these)

Item	Used for
Your real email address	Sending GDPR requests; Meta replies here
Postal address	UK GDPR identity (name + address in letters)
Full legal name	Thomas Gollogly

Screenshots	Post, comments, your photo — saved locally
Post URL	Already in <code>config.example.yaml</code>
A computer	Windows 11, Mac, or Linux

Helpful but optional

Item	Used for
Phone number	Included in letters; Meta may contact you
Passport / ID	Not sent upfront. Meta may ask later to verify identity
Slack webhook	Daily alerts when new URLs appear
VPS (~£5/month)	Hands-off daily monitoring
SerpAPI or TinEye key	Daily reverse-image search

Not required

Item	Notes
Facebook password long-term	GDPR runs on email; see Section 4
Solicitor	Only if Meta + ICO both fail
Police report	Your chosen path avoids this
Payment to Removify	Same process, self-service

4. Facebook login — what matters

You are **currently logged into Facebook**. That is useful now. You plan to **close the account after removal** — that is the correct order.

Works without Facebook login

- Email **privacy@facebook.com** with GDPR letters
- Meta escalation form:
<https://www.facebook.com/help/contact/571927962827151>
- ICO complaint at <https://ico.org.uk/make-a-complaint/>
- Google delisting forms
- All ReclaimKit commands (campaign, monitor, daemon, etc.)

Easier with Facebook login (do these now)

- Confirm the post is still live
- Take fresh screenshots if needed
- Download your Facebook data (Settings → Download your information)
- Save any in-app report reference numbers

After you delete Facebook

- Meta can still process your GDPR request via **email**
- You **cannot** easily check if the post is gone — ask someone still in the group, or wait for Meta's reply

- **Deleting your account does NOT remove the post** — Meta must delete it separately

Recommended order

1. Submit GDPR + escalation (while logged in)
 2. Save screenshots and Meta reply emails locally
 3. Wait up to 1 month for Meta
 4. Confirm removal (check yourself or ask someone in the group)
 5. Google delisting if anything still appears in search
 6. THEN delete/deactivate Facebook
 7. Keep monitoring 3-6 months via ReclaimKit (no Facebook needed)
-

5. Install ReclaimKit

Option A — Local (quickest to start)

```
git clone https://github.com/tgollogly/stop-assholes.git
cd stop-assholes
pip install -r requirements.txt
python3 main.py init
```

This creates `config.yaml` from the template and `evidence/screenshots/` folder.

Option B — VPS with Docker (set-and-forget monitoring)

See [Section 13](#) and `deploy/README.md`.

Verify installation

```
python3 main.py doctor           # health check
python3 -m pytest tests/ -v      # run test suite (12 tests)
```

6. Configure your case

Edit `config.yaml` (never commit this file — it contains personal details).

Subject block — fill with your real details

```
subject:
  full_name: "Thomas Gollogly"
  email: "your.real.email@example.com"      # ← CHANGE THIS
  phone: "+44 XXXX XXXXXX"                  # ← CHANGE THIS
  address_line1: "Your street address"      # ← CHANGE THIS
  city: "Newry"                             # adjust if needed
  county: "County Down"
  postcode: "BTXX XXX"                     # ← CHANGE THIS
  country: "United Kingdom"
```

Case block — already pre-filled for your post

```
case:
  facebook:
```

```
group_name: "AreWeDatingTheSameGuy? Northern Ireland"
post_date: "2025-06-05"
post_caption: "Any red flags Thomas gollogly"
post_url:
"https://www.facebook.com/groups/1054539240086174/posts/1252856073587822/"

reported_to_meta: true
```

Preferences

```
preferences:
  no_police: true
  closing_facebook_after_removal: true
```

Evidence folders

```
evidence:
  screenshots_dir: "./evidence/screenshots"
  output_dir: "./output"
```

Add screenshots

Copy your Facebook screenshots into **evidence/screenshots/**:

- Full post view (photo + caption visible)
- Each harmful comment (scroll and capture)
- Any Meta report confirmation screen

Supported formats: PNG, JPG, JPEG, WEBP.

Secrets (VPS only — use environment variables)

Copy `.env.example` to `.env`:

```
RECLAIMKIT_SMTP_PASSWORD=      # Gmail app password if auto-email
enabled
RECLAIMKIT_SLACK_WEBHOOK=      # Slack incoming webhook URL
RECLAIMKIT_SERPAPI_KEY=        # Optional image search
RECLAIMKIT_TINEYE_KEY=         # Optional image search
```

Never put passwords in `config.yaml` on a VPS. Use `.env` instead.

7. Day 1 — start the campaign

Run these commands in order:

```
# 1. Build evidence pack (hashed screenshots + summary)
python3 main.py evidence

# 2. Start campaign and generate Round 1 letters
python3 main.py campaign init

# 3. Check everything looks correct
python3 main.py doctor
python3 main.py campaign status
```

Or run everything in one go:

```
python3 main.py all
```

What gets created

```
output/
├── campaign/
│   └── state.json                    ← tracks your progress
├── campaign-package-YYYYMMDD.../
│   ├── README.txt
│   ├── round-01-meta/
│   │   ├── meta_r1_gdpr_initial.txt ← EMAIL THIS TO META
│   │   └── SUBMIT.txt               ← step-by-step instructions
│   ├── round-01-google/
│   │   ├── google_r1_defamation.txt
│   │   └── SUBMIT.txt
│   └── evidence-pack-YYYYMMDD.../    ← attach to emails if needed
```

Each letter includes a **case reference** like TG-ER-THOMAS-GOLLO-META-R1. Always put this in the email subject line.

8. How to send Round 1 to Meta

This is the **most important step**. It starts the UK GDPR one-month clock.

Step-by-step

1. Open `output/campaign-package-.../round-01-meta/meta_r1_gdpr_initial.txt`
2. Open your email client (Gmail, Outlook, etc.)
3. **To:** `privacy@facebook.com`
4. **CC (optional):** `dpo@facebook.com`
5. **Subject:** TG-ER-THOMAS-GOLLO-META-R1 – UK GDPR Article 17 Erasure Request – Thomas Gollogly
6. **Body:** Paste the entire letter
7. **Attachments:** All screenshots from `evidence/screenshots/`
8. Send from the **same email address** listed in `config.yaml`
9. Record submission in ReclaimKit:

```
python3 main.py campaign sent --track meta --round 1
```

Tips for a strong submission

- Send from your real email — Meta may reply asking for verification
- Attach clear screenshots showing your face, name, and harmful comments
- Keep a copy of the sent email in a folder (or export to PDF)
- Do **not** send your passport unless Meta explicitly asks in a reply

If you already reported in-app

Round 1 mentions your prior report. Meta sometimes treats GDPR as a separate, stronger legal obligation — send it anyway.

9. Campaign tracks and timeline

ReclaimKit runs three parallel **tracks**. Meta is the priority.

Meta track — 6 rounds

Round	Letter	When to send
R1	GDPR Article 17 initial request	Day 1 — send today
R2	GDPR reminder (no response)	7+ days after R1 with no removal
R3	Trust & Safety escalation	7+ days after R2, or if refused
R4	Formal rebuttal to refusal	When Meta refuses with a reason
R5	Notice of intended ICO complaint	30 days without removal
R6	Post-ICO follow-up to Meta	After ICO accepts complaint

Generate next round automatically:

```
# No response after 7 days
python3 main.py campaign no-response --track meta

# Meta refused - include their reason
python3 main.py campaign refused --track meta --reason "They said it
doesn't violate community standards"

# Manually generate a specific round
python3 main.py campaign next --track meta --round 3
```

Round 3+ also submit the escalation form:

<https://www.facebook.com/help/contact/571927962827151>

(No Facebook login required for this form.)

Recording submissions

Every time you send a letter or submit a form:

```
python3 main.py campaign sent --track meta --round 2
python3 main.py campaign sent --track google --round 1
python3 main.py campaign sent --track ico --round 1 --reference ICO-
REF-12345
```

Check progress anytime

```
python3 main.py campaign status
```

Mark success

When the post and comments are gone:

```
python3 main.py campaign success --note "Post removed confirmed"
```

10. Google delisting (parallel track)

Google removal **hides content from search** — it does not delete the Facebook post. Run this **in parallel** with Meta, especially if your name or photo appears in Google results.

Round 1 — Defamation

1. Open output/campaign-package-.../round-01-google/google_r1_defamation.txt
2. Follow the URL in the letter header (Google Legal Troubleshooter)
3. Paste relevant sections into the form
4. Record: `python3 main.py campaign sent --track google --round 1`

Additional Google tools

Tool	URL
Defamation troubleshooter	https://support.google.com/legal/troubleshooter/111
Personal info removal	https://support.google.com/websearch/contact/content
Results About You	https://myactivity.google.com/results-about-you

Monitor for new URLs

```
python3 main.py monitor
```

Reports save to output/search-monitor-*.txt and .json. Submit delisting for any harmful URLs found.

Google forms are manual (~2 minutes each) — ReclaimKit drafts the text; you paste it in.

11. ICO complaint (if Meta refuses)

If Meta does not remove content within **30 days**, or explicitly refuses your GDPR request, escalate to the **Information Commissioner's Office (ICO)** — free, no police, no court.

When to file

- 30 days passed since Round 1 with no removal
- Meta sent a refusal citing “community standards” or similar
- After Meta Round 4 (rebuttal) failed

How to file

1. Generate ICO letter: `python3 main.py campaign next --track ico`
2. Go to: <https://ico.org.uk/make-a-complaint/>
3. Attach:
 - Evidence pack from `output/evidence-pack-...`
 - All Meta correspondence (your emails + their replies)
 - Screenshots
4. Record: `python3 main.py campaign sent --track ico --round 1 --reference YOUR-ICO-REF`

After ICO

- ICO may contact Meta on your behalf
 - Send Meta Round 5 (ICO notice) when you file
 - Send Meta Round 6 after ICO acknowledges the complaint
-

12. Closing Facebook after removal

Do NOT delete Facebook until removal is confirmed or you have exhausted the GDPR/ICO path.

Run the built-in checklist:

```
python3 main.py close
```

Before deleting your account

- ☐ Download your data: Settings → Download your information
- ☐ Save all Meta reply emails locally
- ☐ Save evidence pack and campaign letters from `output/`
- ☐ Remove apps connected to Facebook (Settings → Apps and websites)
- ☐ Update logins on sites where you used “Log in with Facebook”
- ☐ Confirm post is gone (check while still logged in, or ask someone in the group)

Deactivate vs delete

Action	Effect
Deactivate	Profile hidden; reversible for 30 days
Delete permanently	Cannot log back in; data scheduled for deletion

Path: Settings & privacy → Settings → Accounts Centre → Personal details → Account ownership and control → Deactivation or deletion

After Facebook is closed

- Continue `python3 main.py` monitor monthly for 3–6 months
- Re-submit Google delisting if new URLs appear
- Meta GDPR follow-up still works via email to privacy@facebook.com

13. Daily monitoring and VPS automation

Optional but recommended if you want hands-off daily checks (~£5/month VPS).

What runs automatically (Docker or cron)

Task	Frequency
Web search for your name	Daily
Reverse image search (if API key set)	Daily
Slack alert on new harmful URLs	When found
Auto-generate next Meta letter after 7 days silence	If enabled
Auto-email Meta	Optional (<code>auto_send_emails: true</code>)

Docker quick start

```
cd deploy
docker compose up -d --build
```

Logs: `output/cron.log` and `output/automation-log.jsonl`

Cron (no Docker)

```
0 8 * * * cd /path/to/stop-assholes && python3 main.py daemon once
>> output/cron.log 2>&1
```

Test automation without sending

```
python3 main.py daemon once --dry-run
```

Slack setup

1. Create incoming webhook: <https://api.slack.com/messaging/webhooks>
2. Add URL to `config.yaml` under `automation.slack_webhook_url`
3. Or set `RECLAIMKIT_SLACK_WEBHOOK` in `.env`

Full VPS details: `deploy/README.md`

14. All CLI commands reference

Command	Purpose
<code>python3 main.py init</code>	Create <code>config.yaml</code> and evidence folders

<code>python3 main.py evidence</code>	Build hashed evidence pack
<code>python3 main.py letters</code>	Generate standalone takedown letters (non-campaign)
<code>python3 main.py campaign init</code>	Start campaign + Round 1 package
<code>python3 main.py campaign status</code>	Show progress dashboard
<code>python3 main.py campaign sent --track meta --round N</code>	Record submission
<code>python3 main.py campaign no-response --track meta</code>	7-day silence → next round
<code>python3 main.py campaign refused --track meta --reason "..."</code>	Refusal → rebuttal
<code>python3 main.py campaign next --track meta --round N</code>	Generate specific round
<code>python3 main.py campaign success</code>	Mark content removed
<code>python3 main.py monitor</code>	Scan search for indexed URLs
<code>python3 main.py osint</code>	Document commenter handles
<code>python3 main.py guide</code>	Print removal action guide
<code>python3 main.py close</code>	Facebook closure checklist
<code>python3 main.py doctor</code>	Validate config, deps, letters
<code>python3 main.py daemon once</code>	Run daily automation cycle
<code>python3 main.py daemon once --dry-run</code>	Test without writes/emails
<code>python3 main.py all</code>	Evidence + campaign + osint + monitor

Global option: `--config path/to/config.yaml` (default: `config.yaml`)

15. Windows 11 setup (Docker + WSL)

ReclaimKit is Python and runs best on **WSL2** (Windows Subsystem for Linux). Docker Desktop integrates with WSL.

Step 1 — Install WSL2

Open PowerShell as Administrator:

```
wsl --install
```

Restart if prompted. Ubuntu is the default distribution.

Step 2 — Install Docker Desktop

1. Download from <https://www.docker.com/products/docker-desktop/>
2. Install and enable **WSL 2 backend** in Settings → General
3. Enable integration with your Ubuntu distro in Settings → Resources → WSL Integration

Step 3 — Clone and run in WSL

Open Ubuntu (WSL terminal):

```
sudo apt update && sudo apt install -y python3 python3-pip git
git clone https://github.com/tgollogly/stop-assholes.git
cd stop-assholes
pip install -r requirements.txt
python3 main.py init
# Edit config.yaml with: nano config.yaml
# Add screenshots to evidence/screenshots/
python3 main.py campaign init
python3 main.py doctor
```

Step 4 — Optional VPS-style Docker monitoring

From WSL, inside the repo:

```
cd deploy
docker compose up -d --build
docker compose logs -f
```

Accessing files from Windows

WSL files live at `\\wsl$\Ubuntu\home\<username>\stop-assholes\` in File Explorer. You can copy screenshots there directly.

Testing on Windows (no VPS)

You do **not** need Docker for the core workflow. Local Python in WSL is enough:

```
python3 main.py campaign init
# Email Meta manually using the generated letter
python3 main.py campaign sent --track meta --round 1
python3 main.py monitor
```

16. Costs and comparison to paid services

Option	Cost	Notes
ReclaimKit (local)	£0	Your time only
VPS monitoring	~£5/month	Hetzner, DigitalOcean, etc.
SerpAPI (image search)	~\$50/month free tier available	Optional
Removify	£400–£2,000 per item	Same forms and emails
NI solicitor	£500–£5,000+	Only if Meta + ICO fail

ReclaimKit automates what paid services do manually: letter drafting, escalation timing, monitoring, and record-keeping.

17. FAQ

Do I need my Facebook password?

Not for the removal process. GDPR runs on your email and postal address. Login helps you check the post and take screenshots now, but follow-up works without it.

Do I need to send my passport?

Not in Round 1. Meta may ask for ID in a reply email to verify you are the data subject. Only send if they request it.

I already reported the post in-app. Do I still send GDPR?

Yes. In-app reports and GDPR Article 17 requests are different channels. GDPR creates a legal deadline Meta must meet.

Will deleting Facebook remove the post?

No. The post must be removed by Meta while your request is active. Close your account **after** removal.

Can this hurt my US travel or create a public record?

This process is **private correspondence** with Meta/Google/ICO — not a public court case or police record. Google delisting **reduces** public visibility. Avoid posting about the case on public blogs (higher SEO risk than a private Facebook group).

Can ReclaimKit identify who posted the comments?

No. Anonymous Facebook handles cannot be deanonymized without Meta legal disclosure. Focus on **content removal**, not confronting individuals.

What if Meta says “doesn’t violate community standards”?

Record the refusal and generate Round 4 (rebuttal):

```
python3 main.py campaign refused --track meta --reason "Pasted  
Meta's exact reply here"
```

Then proceed toward ICO if still not removed after 30 days.

How long does it take?

Stage	Typical timeframe
Meta GDPR response	Up to 1 calendar month
Google delisting	Days to weeks
ICO complaint	Weeks to months
Full campaign	1–3 months in most cases

18. Troubleshooting

Run the doctor

```
python3 main.py doctor
```

Checks: config file exists, required fields filled, post URL valid, screenshots present, letters generate correctly, dependencies installed.

Common issues

Problem	Fix
config.yaml not found	Run <code>python3 main.py init</code>
No campaign found	Run <code>python3 main.py campaign init</code>
No screenshots found	Add PNG/JPG files to <code>evidence/screenshots/</code>
Monitor import error	<code>pip install duckduckgo-search</code>
SMTP auto-email fails	Use Gmail App Password, not main password; set <code>RECLAIMKIT_SMTP_PASSWORD</code>
Letters missing your name	Edit <code>config.yaml</code> subject block

Run tests

```
python3 -m pytest tests/ -v
```

All 12 tests should pass.

19. Support contacts (no police required)

Service	Contact	Use for
ICO	<code>https://ico.org.uk</code> · 0303 123 1113	Meta GDPR failures
Citizens Advice NI	0800 915 4605	General guidance
Meta DPO	<code>privacy@facebook.com</code> · <code>dpo@facebook.com</code>	Data erasure requests

Your config sets `no_police: true`. PSNI (101) and solicitors remain optional if Meta and ICO both fail.

20. Checklist — print and tick off

Phase 1 — Setup (Day 1)

- ☐ Clone repo and `pip install -r requirements.txt`
- ☐ Run `python3 main.py init`
- ☐ Fill real email, address, phone in `config.yaml`

- ☐ Copy screenshots to evidence/screenshots/
- ☐ Run `python3 main.py evidence`
- ☐ Run `python3 main.py campaign init`
- ☐ Run `python3 main.py doctor` — all checks green

Phase 2 — Meta removal (Week 1)

- ☐ Email Round 1 letter to privacy@facebook.com
- ☐ Subject line includes case reference TG-ER-THOMAS-GOLLO-META-R1
- ☐ Attach all screenshots
- ☐ Run `python3 main.py campaign sent --track meta --round 1`
- ☐ Save sent email and any Meta reply

Phase 3 — Google (parallel)

- ☐ Run `python3 main.py monitor`
- ☐ Submit Google Round 1 if URLs found
- ☐ Enable Results About You on Google account
- ☐ Run `python3 main.py campaign sent --track google --round 1`

Phase 4 — Follow-up (Weeks 2–4)

- ☐ If no removal in 7 days: `campaign no-response --track meta`
- ☐ If Meta refuses: `campaign refused --track meta --reason "..."`
- ☐ Round 3+: submit escalation form at facebook.com/help/contact/571927962827151
- ☐ If 30 days pass: ICO complaint + Meta Round 5

Phase 5 — After removal

- ☐ Confirm post gone (while logged in or via someone in group)
- ☐ Run `python3 main.py campaign success`
- ☐ Download Facebook data
- ☐ Run `python3 main.py close and follow checklist`
- ☐ Delete/deactivate Facebook account
- ☐ Monitor monthly 3–6 months: `python3 main.py monitor`

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